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# In new Assembly district, Nazarian sets up race with fellow Democrat Laura Friedman

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Assemblyman Adrin Nazarian, D-Van Nuys, has announced he will run for the newly created 44th Assembly District, encompassing Sunland-Tujunga, La Crescenta, Burbank and part of Glendale.

The move sets up a head-to-head race for the seat with fellow Democrat, Assemblywoman Laura Friedman, D-Burbank, who earlier announced her run for the seat.

"I'm in," read the subject line of an email to supporters this week announcing Nazarian's run for next year's election.

Nazarian, a former chief of staff to City Councilman Paul Krekoran, has represented the 46th Assembly District for nine years. The district — in the form it's been in for the last 10 years — contains much of the central San Fernando Valley, including Sherman Oaks, Studio City, Valley Village, Van Nuys, Lake Balboa, Toluca Lake and some of North Hollywood. It's in between Jesse Gabriel's 45th District to the west, Luz Rivas' district to the north, and Friedman's to the east.

But under newly redrawn district maps, finalized last week by the state's 14-member Independent Citizens Redistricting Commission and delivered to the Secretary of State on Monday, the boundaries shifted eastward, putting Nazarian, Friedman and Rivas all in the the newly created 44th Assembly seat.

That is because they all resided within its new boundaries. Under state law, members must live in the district they represent. That means somebody had to do some house hunting, if they wanted to remain in the Assembly.

Rivas, who represents the 39th Assembly seat and is chair of the Assembly's Natural Resources Committee, announced via Twitter that she will move into the newly redrawn 43rd and run for the seat, which encompasses Pacoima, Panorama City, Sun Valley, San Fernando and Sylmar.

"About 70% of her current district is in the redrawn 43rd, so she already represents the vast majority of its residents, said her campaign consultant, Roy Behr.

But that left Friedman and Nazarian — as the saying goes, there isn't room enough for both of them — aiming for one seat.

Friedman, chair of the Assembly's transportation committee, announced her run for the 44th Assembly District on Dec. 21.

The new 44th stretches from the 405 in Sherman Oaks through Valley Village and North Hollywood all the way east, just east of the Glendale Freeway but which stops at the border with Pasadena. It encompasses areas such as Montrose and Verdugo City in its northeast flank.

"From environmental protection and affordable housing to gun safety and patients rights, I am proud of the issues that I have championed over the last five years in the Assembly," Friedman said in Dec. 21 tweet string pegged on her announcement.

Nazarian, too, was getting out the word.

"District lines may change, but the work continues, and I am committed to ensuring these communities are

represented well in the California State Assembly," Nazarian said.

In an L.A. County region where incumbents tend to be Democrats, the newly redrawn districts offered more open doors to blue-on-blue races at the state and federal level.

State Assemblywoman Cristina Garcia, D-Bell Gardens, will run for Congress, she announced Thursday, Dec. 23, setting up a battle with Long Beach Mayor Robert Garcia — for a newly created district that merged areas long represented by two Democratic powerhouses.

The newly created 42nd District essentially combines the current 47th — minus the Orange County portions — and 40th districts. That will create a Latino-majority district anchored by Long Beach but also including key cities Cristina Garcia currently represents in the Assembly, including Bell and Downey.

This story has been updated to reflect that Friedman is chair of the Assembly's transportation committee.

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